

India Cements Ltd. (INDIACEM)

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Call: May 2023

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Dear Sirs,

Sub.: Transcript of Investors Call / Analysts' Meet - Disclosure under

Regulation 30 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure

Requirements) Regulations, 2015

In continuation to our letter dated 24.05.2023, please find enclosed the transcript of the conference call (concall) held on 24.05.2023 with representatives of various Investors / Analysts on the audited Financial Results of the Company for the Quarter and Year ended March 31, 2023.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

for THE INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED

oil

COMPANY SECRETARY

Encl.. As above

Registered Office: Dhun Building, 827, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002.

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"India Cements Q4 & FY23 Earnings Conference Call"

May 24, 2023

MANAGEMENT : MR. N. SRINIVASAN – VICE CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR , INDIA CEMENTS

MODERATOR : MR. VAIBHAV AGARWAL – PHILLIP CAPITAL (INDIA)
PRIVATE LIMITED

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the India Cements Q4 FY23 Call hosted by PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited .

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' and then '0' on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Vaibhav Agarwal from PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited. Thank you and over to you, Sir.

Vaibhav Agarwal : Thank you Aman. Good morning everyone. On behalf of PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited we welcome you to the Q4& FY23 Call of the India Cements Limited.

On the call we have with us the entire Senior Management Team of India Cements.

I would like to mention on behalf of The India Cements Limited and its management that certain statements that maybe made or discussed on this conference call maybe forward -looking statements related to future developments and the current performance. These statements are subject to a number of risks, uncertainties and other important factors that may cause actual developmental results to differ materially from the statements made. The India Cements Limited and the management of the company assumes no obligation to publicly alter or update these forward -looking statements whether as a result of new information or future events or otherwise. I will now hand over the floor to Mr. N. Srinivasan – Vice Chairman and Managing Director of the company for his opening remarks which will follow up and directing Q&A. Thank you over to you sir, sir.

Management : Thank you Vaibhav. The results, if one can say are startling. When the cost of coal , which is our main fuel , skyrockets from about \$60 to \$300 there is very little that management can do except grin and bear it. In our case for almost 7 months, 8 months, 9 months the cost of coal was astronomically high and it has now shown some signs of coming down. To give you an example the cost in cement industry we look at coal has cost per calorie of heat that goes into the kiln. So, what was Rs. 1 per calorie went up to Rs. 2.8 per calorie. So, this kind of increase cannot be borne by any management, so you have to accept the loss and try to mitigate it in several ways including working at the consumption.

Looking at the consumption , no real research has been done into the heat of reaction where the limestone converts itself into clinker. So, therefore any improvements that have been made have been done by the machinery manufacturers who have reduced the heat consumption by trying to

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see the less heat goes away, that all the heat is generated is used etcetera . So, therefore in a sense when the cost of heat goes up there is very little that we can do.

As far as India Cements is concerned , there are still a few areas that we can work on. We want to work on in the two, three of our plans on changing some equipment and so we have a CAPEX program which will reduce the heat consumption by changing equipments which are known to consume less heat . We have engaged experts from FLSmidth as well as Krupp Polysius to advise us and their report is almost ready and we are in a position to implement some of these changes. You can ask "you are making such losses how are you going to finance this? " Well, what we have done is we have identified some land which will not be used by cement factory which is away and that land can be disposed -off and I think that that will be sufficient for our purpose of not only repairing our plants, fitting in new equipment and even if necessary if we need money for repayment

ent this will be handy also. So, we have to repay about Rs. 450 crores this year we will be compliant, we will repay the full Rs. 450 crores plus interest so there will be no default from our side.

These are the preliminary remarks that I have. I would be happy to respond to any questions that you have.

Moderator : Thank you very much. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. First question is from Navin Sahadeo from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Navin Sahadeo : And just before we begin the questions can I just request to share volumes and other data of like those windmill shipping which helps us understand these results better I will come back in queue for questions.

Management : Yes, volume for the quarter was 27.85 lakh tons including clinker of 0.10 Lakh Tons.

Navin Sahadeo : Those other revenues and EBITDA if you can share from the other business segment?

Management : Shipping was around 13 crore revenue and 5.6 crores EBITDA; windmill was around only 0.73 Crore and practically nil EBITDA. RMC was 25 crores income and EBITDA of close to 1.8 crores.

Navin Sahadeo : So, then my first question is about prices of course we have seen I think prices have been under pressure this quarter as well, but is it fair to say that current prices because especially I believe the states like Tamil Nadu and Kerala where all A category players particularly I think have been very aggressive especially in the last couple of months, so is it fair to say that in these markets particularly the current prices could be at least 5%, 7% lower versus March quarter and in general your commentary on the price and the outlook that will help ?

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Management : You see as far as the price is concerned everybody; I think generally the cement industry recognizes that this price at which we are selling cement is not from the point of view of demand.

This year the demand is good, in fact almost all the companies are running full. So, the tendency amongst the most companies is to sell the last gram of cement which is not a good price. What happens is when everybody rushes to sell prices are casualty. So, that is the reason why in spite of people wanting to have a better price it is not there in the marketplace. The marketplace is cutthroat in spite of the fact that we are at full production there is strain. At full production the prices should go up, but instead they are stagnant. So, to answer your question on pricing at the moment although there is almost full production prices have not gone up, but my expectation is it will be only a matter of time before it goes up.

Management : I mean to answer one more question of yours prices as compared to March have not slipped. It is at the same level or better than March, but then it is at a very low level.

Navin Sahadeo : This question was in for Tamil Nadu and Kerala states because historically?

Management : Tamil Nadu Kerala specifically, prices as compared to exit price of March are better.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Rajesh Ravi from HDFC Securities. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Ravi : Sir, could you share the annual numbers clinker production and cement production and sales volume for the full year please?

Management : For the quarter?

Rajesh Ravi : No, full year FY23?

Management : 73 lakh tons of clinker, 97.3 lakh tons of cement.

Rajesh Ravi : This is production 97.3?

Management : Yes.

Rajesh Ravi : And cement and clinker sales?

Management : 98.93.

Rajesh Ravi : This includes clinker or that is separate?

Management : Clinker is included in that 1.37 included in overall sales.

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Rajesh Ravi : Sir, earlier we were looking at the South market the price difference to minimize and go away, what is the scenario currently on that?

Management : I could

not get your question.

Rajesh Ravi : The price difference whereby people were invoicing and then later on discounting and this was creating lot of prices were volatile, has the situation is it improving in Southern markets?

Management : No, price difference concepts still continue. So, there is no change in the way the people are marketing.

Management : If companies are firm this question of price difference will not arise because of the weakness of the selling force that this price came down.

Rajesh Ravi : You have mentioned that March exit prices have slightly improved, but how is the situation compared to March quarter because if I look at your realization for March quarter it is down almost 5% quarter-on-quarter, so the current prices versus average of March how would that number be?

Management : Slightly better, but this quarter is still not over if you are comparing quarter as of now it is better. Q2 one half of the quarter it is better than March quarter.

Rajesh Ravi : And how has the fuel cost consumption basis in March quarter it was around Rs. 2.95 for December quarter?

Management : 2.7 it was in March quarter.

Rajesh Ravi : And for the Q1 what is the number you are looking at sir?

Management : Maybe around 2.3 to 2.4

Rajesh Ravi : So, you are looking at good savings which may improve the numbers, is that understanding

right?

Management : Cost will come down.

Rajesh Ravi : But would that reflect into margins or do you expect that it may get passed on in terms of delivering volumes?

Management : You have taken everything from us, you have set the prices are slightly better than when I say prices that is what we get in the company actually it is better than the last quarter and the price of coal is slightly lower on the variable cost basis I am talking of variable cost level.

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Rajesh Ravi : You mentioned earlier in the call that you are looking to monetize some of the land parcels which will give you some leeway to do some refurbishment CAPEX, could you quantify what sort of land monetization you are looking at and what sort of CAPEX number you are looking for FY24?

Management : See, we are expecting to monetize about 400, 500 acres of land. We are expecting that we shall sell it for a reasonable sum. See we are in the process of finalizing what CAPEX that we want to do because there are options, we want to see what will give us the best to fit. So, we are in the process. All I can say is that it will be towards grinding because in summer some of our plants we have got roller mills and if changed to vertical roller mills the drop in power is enormous and also some changes in the Pyroprocessing. I am afraid I am unable to give you details.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Amit Murarka from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.

Amit Murarka : Just a couple of questions on the capacity side like we have seen some announcements happening on expansions now in South like we were not seeing that earlier. So, like anyways Shree Cement is coming up with a plant and even UltraTech is working on the same and Dalmia is doing some debottlenecking. So, this highly competitive intensity that you mentioned earlier like could this now continue with these new units coming up?

Management : I think very little new units are coming up. If you take the entire South as a whole has capacity of almost 180 million tons. If 2 million to 3 million of debottlenecking and addition come it is not going to make much of a difference.

Amit Murarka : No sir understand, but companies themselves are not expanding and now they are which means that they are seeing higher utilization in their own capacities, existing capacity, does it mean that they will continue to be aggressive in the market and raise utilization levels for their existing capacity before the new one starts?

Man

agement : Actually, that is true that the capacity utilization of most companies have improved in the last year because of infra demand coming back to the South which was not there earlier. So, there are headroom, some people would like to add on capacity, but it is not easy people who have started the work will take another 1 and half years, 2 years to do it and demand of 150 million tons including what goes outside. I think as MD said 3 million, 4 million, 5 million and even 10 million ton coming get absorbed. So, one has to wait and see the people have to also make money so I do not think it will impact the prices anywhere the prices, anyway, the prices are at the lowest level it has to only go up.

Amit Murarka : And also, on the limestone auction could you just throw some light on what is the update on the Tamil Nadu auctions?

Management : Nothing has happened it is standstill. No auction has taken place in South.

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Management : I think going further most of the limestone wherein land have been spoken for and most of the limestone has been also used. It is not like the vast tracts of limestone unexploited which is available which will add to capacity. People can get by with their existing limestone that they have. I do not think it will support great expansion in the future.

Moderator : Thank you. The next question follow up from Navin Sahadeo from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Navin Sahadeo : I had two questions one is that our volumes for this year as you said are more like 9.7 million in the year which is still look at from a year perspective or industry perspective way below what we did already in FY19, so as a broader industry level our understanding is that in FY23 the industry has surpassed the volume that it had South Industry specifically, has surpassed volumes that it did in FY19 because you had two bad years 20 and 21 all thanks to COVID in the interim, but there has been recovery thereafter, so just wanted to get a sense that with players or other peers growing like 30% to 40% kind of a growth that we are seeing, but ours is not that much do you still think that having lost some market share the pricing overall will still improve or you think that this year again companies in general may want to get the lost market share to the large company?

Management : Actually, if you look at the scenario for the South I mean I am talking on the South. It is the fact

that at the moment there is no surplus clinker available. A few companies are trying to debottleneck a few couple of companies are trying to set up grinding units, one Company set up an integrated plant in Kurnool, but the question of what will the price be that I will wait to see with this kind of full production price has to go up, but it is a matter of time.

Management : Navin, as our MD said what we have done when you make there is no secret that we are making loss we have made loss. So, we have to pick and choose markets. What we have done this year I wish I could give the data to you, but we have started selling more into our core markets. While the number 9 plus something million looks a little low as compared to what we have done in 2019, but actually if we look at in our core markets we have increased exponentially that is where we are working on and as we go along our plan is to go to that number which you are looking at because we have not added any capacity, but it will run full capacity that much we know. MD said that we have already seen the industry working in full capacity with the growth still of double digit in South I think it will be very easy without disturbing the price to get that volume. This is the plan of scheme. So, we have done Phase -1 of increasing our sale in the right segment in the right market. Now next is to get that delta increase and go to the full level

this is
the plan for this year.

Navin Sahadeo : So, safe to assume that despite large players like going for pushing volumes far aggressively it is fair to assume that overall industry pricing environment can improve in this fiscal, is that the message we can take ?

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Management : Exactly because I do not think if you look at all the big players I mean I do not want to name them, brands which make a difference in the market, their actual price is a concern be it Tamil Nadu, whether it is Kerala. So, everybody seemed to be settled there. The question is whether they will increase the price we have to wait and watch, that is what we are saying. Theoretically if you look at it if people are operating at 85% plus normally prices go up.

Navin Sahadeo : My second question was about the CAPEX that we can expect at the company level for 24 and 25 in light of the initiatives like changing of some critical equipments to improve the efficiencies, so in general what is the CAPEX for FY24 and 25 are we looking at and by when do you expect these especially these large equipments or critical equipments to get replaced?

Management : The CAPEX estimate can be about 600 crores. It should be completed in about 18 to 20 months.

Navin, as we said we are waiting for the report to come and what MD said is we are targeting three, four factories. So, given that number will be around the number as MD mentioned and span of expansions the CAPEX will be based on how the project report comes. So, it will be around two years, you can take it, in two years' time we will have to spend this much.

Moderator : Thank you. The next question is from Shyam Sundar Sriram from Franklin Templeton. Please go ahead.

Shyam Sundar Sriram : Sir my question is more at the industry level trying to understand the dynamics between within states in the South we are given to understand that these gray cement pricing in Hyderabad is now say very close to the pricing in Chennai historically and the Tamil Nadu pricing used to be at a premium to that. Now given that has it stopped some of the players from the that cluster selling cement into Tamil Nadu, Chennai and does it mean that the players with plants production within Tamil Nadu get to gain market share here in this state?

Management : Fortunately, we are into all clusters. So, we cannot say that you know Tamil Nadu is not our cluster or Andhra is not our cluster, but what possibly is happening that Tamil Nadu players are focusing more into Tamil Nadu, Kerala and the cluster of Andhra, Telangana are focusing more into Andhra, Telangana. Fortunately, we have demand in every state. So, people are able to evacuate the cement in the lower freight zone and that is logical. So, as we have been saying as most of the companies are already operating at the optimum level be it in Tamil Nadu, be it in Nalgonda cluster or be it Tandur cluster. So, it is just that we have found a new model of coexistence. The prices are low, but as I said that if people are operating at close to full capacity is all the more driven. We do believe that the prices automatically will go up and we have to see how long it takes, but looks like stability will come and the prices will move on, this is our feeling.

Shyam Sundar Sriram : One other point now Karnataka recently went through an election and we are given to understand that probably some of the infra contracts are being reviewed, now in the South I think Telangana

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is also coming up for election later this calendar year. Now, given these do we still continue to think that South demand will continue to be healthy robust for this FY24 ?

Management : Please try to understand from where the demand is coming like additional demand, the demand

was always there. Additional demand is coming primarily from

one is the road project which is

driven by Center normally and some states also have their own projects. Number two is from Metro and Infra projects like that. Number three is for real estate in a place like Hyderabad which is driven primarily because of the economic factors is a private players who are doing the whole thing, there is no more coalition on other thing. So, these are the demand which will not go away because Hyderabad has become a city which is bustling with activities. Andhra has pockets of activities happening mostly driven by government, but also road projects of Central government same way Tamil Nadu, Kerala first time is seen so many roads being made. So, I do not see especially with 24 election coming and I am not looking at people I mean some of these activities will only go up it will not come down. So, personally if you ask me the demand up to 24 can be taken for granted the growth and demand can be taken for granted. I mean some here, there some state government projects can get delayed or whatever, but what is being driven is that Chennai, Bangalore Road now that will not stop because of this election or no election. So, up to 24 we can keep seeing this activity going on and lot many much metro players are also coming up you are aware of that. Our feeling is that till 24 there is no looking back, this is our feeling.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Mangesh Bhadang from Centrum Broking. Please go ahead.

Mangesh Bhadang : Sir, you mentioned that Southern utilization is at a linker utilization is very close to full and the overall cement capacity is 180 million tons, just wanted to know what is the cement utilization or cement production in the Southern region in FY23?

Management : See we do not get this data anywhere so it is all estimate, but believe it is around 1.40 million, 150 million tons given that lot of movement is happening outside South it goes a lot of quantity is going into Maharashtra and Western side and on east side will be Odisha and West Bengal. So, this is our estimate. I cannot give you the number because we do not have any data from any sources.

Mangesh Bhadang : Second question is related to you mentioned that you would be trying to address the specific heat consumption issues those costs being higher. So, just wanted to know what are the steps that you mentioned that you are taking, what is the scope of CAPEX there and how much cost saving you expect from this?

Management : See what we are looking at is the whole Pyro processing system depends upon maximum heat to be utilized in the process, in the system. So, therefore the radiation losses, other losses should be cut to the bone not only that now all plants have started using waste heat recovery that is the India Cements Limited

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waste heat that goes out is trapped and they used to generate power. So, therefore we are seeing a much more energy efficient cement industry than before.

Mangesh Bhadang : So, we are looking to setup WHRS is it?

Management : We have already initiated one plant for WHRS project. We are also looking at the project which already investments have been to put in AFR in all the kilns and somewhere we are also looking at and the other projects as I told you will be taken up after we have the project report in hand from the experts, but all of them will be towards efficiency improvement either on the Pyroprocessing side or on the grinding side it can be a WHR and obviously the most important thing which we have already initiated is the we are going to put out plant of solar power in Tamil Nadu. So, that also will help us in power cost reduction. These are the initiatives we have already taken.

Mangesh Bhadang : Sir is on the pricing in South so historically as the previous participants also mentioned that we have seen the South prices have historic a

lly being higher, but is it because that we have seen

higher demand for the past two years that the pricing has taken backseat and once this very high demand growth phase is over probably the pricing growth again can come back to these markets?

Management : See, on pricing very difficult to say when there are so many people on the way, but I believe that when the utilization goes up normally the prices become steady and improved. As of now are we seeing it today? No, we are not seeing it in the marginal improvements have happened as I mentioned earlier.

Mangesh Bhadang : So, even though despite lower utilization we used to have relatively good pricing, but now that the utilization so it is basically the reverse has happened, so just wanted to check if the demand actually stops whether the intensity of the players to push more volumes in the market would stop and thereby help pricing?

Management : Exactly. So, once you have reached their optimal capacity then that urge to sell that extra ton will go far away from it. As we said that as of now we have not reached anywhere near that, but once that realization comes that I cannot sell more even by reducing the price I have to do the same volume then people will start increasing the price. That is what happens everywhere if you see other region whether it is North or whether West. Once domestic utilization reaches a

particular level look at Gujarat typically with the reasonable capacity utilization, prices are very steady at a very high level. So, we expect the same thing in South it will take little time.

Mangesh Bhadang : Sir one more question that we had sold our limestone mine in MP to JSW Group so that money has been received and or where has been it been utilized?

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Management : The entire procedure is pre-closed about Rs. 600 crores received and it has been utilized partly for improving efficiencies in some of the plants, working capital requirements and also for meeting the deficit in terms of cash flow.

Mangesh Bhadang : Nothing pending right sir there?

Management : About 3 crores is pending.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Rajesh Ravi from HDFC Securities. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Ravi : Just on the previous questions you mentioned that you would be doing the WHR project and AFR, so could you quantify what sort of WHR you are you looking at and AFR and all total CAPEX outlay for these?

Management : Sir, we are actually looking at putting up a WHR plant of 8 megawatt at one of our plants.

Management : So, the process of putting our feeding system once that is ready we will start using AFR to a higher level I cannot say anything right now, but our plan is to go up to more than double digit .

Rajesh Ravi : At company level?

Management : Yes, at company level this is the plan. First, we are putting up the feeding system.

Rajesh Ravi : So, how we understand is like you said that 600 crores odd you will be investing over next two years to replace your ball mills across 3, 4 plants and then 8 megawatt WHR that would be around 100 crores?

Management : Yes approximately.

Rajesh Ravi : And AFR would be costing how much sir for you across plants that you are planning?

Management : It depends upon the plant size and all that. So, depending upon the plant it may vary from 2 crores, 3 crores, 5 crores like that.

Rajesh Ravi : And you mentioned 580 crore is the repayment due in FY24 and in addition to the interest outgo or this is inclusive of that?

Management : The interest is separate.

Rajesh Ravi : So, almost 800 crores would be what you will be paying towards that interest ?

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Management : We have principle repayment of about 450 crores plus some interest payment is also included in the 540 crores.

Rajesh Ravi : For FY24 if I look at 450 crores plus

suppose the last year interest?

Management : 450 crores will be the principle repayment.

Rajesh Ravi : And annual interest cost 200 to 250 crores?

Management : Yes.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Navin Sahadeo from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Navin Sahadeo : Just one last question from me what is the current net debt both at the stand alone and the consol level as at the end of FY23?

Management : Standalone debt as at March '23 is 2,919 crores including working capital.

Navin Sahadeo : And for consol ?

Management : 2,939 .

Navin Sahadeo : This is after adjusting for the money that we have received from the sale of Springway Mining and everything ?

Management : Correct.

Moderator : Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen this would be our last question . I now hand the conference back to Mr. Vaibhav Agarwal for closing comments.

Vaibhav Agarwal : Sir, I had a few questions actually sir you mentioned about this WHRS project being implemented one of your plans, so sir incrementally many of the plants having a quite a lot of vintage, so what is your expectations of the total capacity, how many plants could potentially be supporting this WHRS projects in the future, just your initial thought and maybe we can avoid the report, but what is your thoughts and what kind of savings we can expect from this?

Management : The issue is Vaibhav wastage at the plant. The four stage pre heater lends itself to a WHRS. So, also, we have different types of power. We have power, which is wind power, we have thermal power. So, depending upon the shortage of power the need we will take a call.

Vaibhav Agarwal : Sir, my second question was that you have provided for an extraordinary of nearly 113 crores in the current quarter which is write off for Andhra Pradesh gas this company write off, so sir can

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you throw some more light on this write off and what kind of power was this company helping us and is this also one of the reasons why our cost increase in power and fuel is reasonably high than many of the other peers in the industry?

Management : I will give the exact numbers Vaibhav, but basically it was we had a share in APGPCL which was producing power from the gas where we used to get 23 megawatt of power which was used in our and it was obviously at a much lower price than the grid power. Now because the gas prices went up and it does some \$10 per mmbtu and they said the allocation also is not there and therefore this whole organization that is APGPCL has gone into sort of it is not working now. So, it has gone to a closure sort of a thing. So, that is why we have provided for it as if that we do not have an issue there.

Management : In any case APGPCL did not get the gas allocation. So, they are not able to run their turbines that is one. Point number two is the price at which if the gas is being supplied today it is about \$6.04, I think so even at that rate the power from APGPCL will be more expensive than electricity board power. So, therefore they had to go into a full stop.

Vaibhav Agarwal : So, this is sort of a permanent write-off for us as of now?

Management : We have provided for an impairment it is not written-off we have provided for an impairment in the value.

Management : In the plant and machinery is in perfect condition. The only question is suppose tomorrow they reduce the gas power to \$. 3 or \$. 2.50 like old prices then it will work. So, therefore but we cannot wait for that, so we have made a provision for that.

Management : At this point in time, it is not economically viable.

Vaibhav Agarwal : Any specific one off in the current quarter apart from this or anything else which is one off item at operating level?

Management : No sir.

Vaibhav Agarwal : Sir one more last question would be sir that you have been like on the whole call that our

commentary on pricing has not been very confident and near term of price increases and observing the numbers of almost all other cement companies actually we have closed the year with a negative EBITDA of nearly Rs. 175 a ton and most of the other companies are doing reasonably okay, but maybe ahead of Rs. 500, Rs. 600 also in your region as well, so sir what will be your take as to why the pricing would come back and what can we expect I am not asking about specific guidance, but FY24 -25 from a negative 170 trajectory where can we probably target ourselves with the power savings coming in, can we go back to that 500, 600 levels of India Cements Limited

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EBITDA per ton or you think that we will still be closing at breakeven levels for FY24 -FY25 your initial thoughts on numbers going forward?

Management : The initial thought is that during the next financial year the situation will be much better. When we are operating at close to full capacity prices will go up, that is the axiom that all of us follow. So, small increase will do a lot to us. So, therefore we are expecting prices to go up.

Management : EBITDA, it depends on two things. One is the cost of production, which went up by that was Rs. 1,700 per ton, it went up for us for simple reason because the power fuel cost was high and we could not run our power plant because the cost of coal was so high. Now these two things are changing now I mean you are aware of the thing now cost of coal is coming down almost on a daily basis. So, we should see getting there the prices will take some time before they go up, but definitely there should be an improvement given that nobody wants to lose money. So, we hope that the saving on the cost side and that is why we are very confident that our EBITDA will be now go back to previous level.

Vaibhav Agarwal : And so one question if I may asked to Srinivasan sir basically we keep on getting a lot of questions from investors with regards to what is the road map for industry consolidation so sir do you think so that the industry is now fairly consolidated and the industry growth from here on companies growth would be more from organic route and in organic consolidation will be having lesser chances in going forward or do you think so that there are still players in the industry who are willing to take an exit you being a stalwart over the industry what is your take on this as per your industry interaction?

Management : I think it will be more organic futures.

Moderator : Thank you. Next question is from Rajesh Ravi from HDFC Securities. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Ravi : Just one clarification this land monetization which you are looking at would that be on stand alone books or in the consol entity?

Management : It will be on standalone books.

Rajesh Ravi : And you have a reasonable chance of monetizing them over next 12 to 18 months?

Management : Yes, very good chance.

Moderator : Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that would be our last question. I now have the conference talked to Mr. Vaibhav Agarwal for closing comments. Thank you and over to you .

India Cements Limited

May 24,2023

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Vaibhav Agarwal : Thank you. On behalf of PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited we thank the management for India Cements for the call and many thanks to the participants for joining the call. Thank you very much sir.

Moderator : Thank you very much. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Phillip Capital (India) Private Limited that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Aug 2023

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: Nov 2023

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: Feb 2024

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: May 2024

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) THE INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED Corporate Office : Coromandel Towers, 93, Santhome High Road, Karpagam Avenue, R.A. Puram, Chennai - 600 028. Phone : 044-2852 1526, 2857 2100

Fax : 044-2851 7198, Grams : 'INDCEMENT'

CIN : L26942TN1946PLC000931 M

SH/

BSE Limited

Corporate Relationship Dept.

First Floor New Trading Ring

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MUMBAI 400 001.

Scrip Code : 530005 24.05 2024

National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Exchange Plaza 5th Floor,

Plot No .C/1 G Block

Bandra-Kurla Complex

Bandra (E)

MUMBAI 400 051.

Scrip Code : INDIACEM

Dear Sirs,

Sub.: Transcript of Investors Call / Analysts' Meet - Disclosure under Regulation

30 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and

Regulations, 2015 Disclosure Requirements)

In continuation to our letter dated 20.05.2024, please find enclosed the transcript of the conference call (concall) held on 20.05.2024 with representatives of various Investors / Analysts on the audited financial results of the Company for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2024.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

for THE INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED

(2 0)

COMPANY SECRETARY

Encl As above

Registered Office Dhun Building, 827, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600 002.

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Page 1 of 9

"India Cements Limited Q 4 FY '24 Earnings
Conference Call "

May 20, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. N. SRINIVASAN – VICE CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR , INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. VAIBHAV AGARWAL – PHILLIP CAPITAL (INDIA)
PRIVATE LIMITED

Page 2 of 9

Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen , good day and welcome to the Earnings Call for quarter and year ended 31st March 20 24 of India Cements Limited hosted by PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' then '0' on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Vaibhav Agarwal from PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited. Thank you , and over to you.

Vaibhav Agarwal: Thank you, Yashashree. Good afternoon everyone. On behalf of PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited , we welcome you to the Q4 and FY '24 Earnings Call for India Cements Limited.

On the call we have with us the entire Senior Management Team of the India Cements Limited .

Now, I would like to mention on behalf of the India Cements and its management that certain statements that we made or discuss on this conference call may be forward -looking statements related to future development and based on current expectations. These statements are subject to a number of risks, uncertainties and other important factors that may cause actual developments and results t o differ materially from the statements made. The India Cements Limited and the Management of the Company assumes no obl igation to publicly alter or update these forward -looking statements, whether as a result of new information or future events or otherwise.

I would now hand over the floor to Mr. N. Srinivasan – Vice Chairman and Managing Director of India Cements for his opening remarks, which will be followed by interactive Q&A . Thank you, and over to you, Srinivasan sir .

Management: Thank you , Vaibhav . I have a short opening statement. You see, the last few years we were in the boondocks. We had a tough time . Fuel prices shot up . Our costs were high. We had a number of collections of plants of various vintages . So, as a result of it getting to a low cost of production and one was difficult.

What we have done ? We have now systematized our approach to costs. For example, what was 3,500 year ago is 3050, this substantial drop is the drop of coal price plus our economies. This year we expect to go further.

Now, as far as clinker, we are installing a waste heat recovery at Chilamakuru , which will substantially reduce the power and some of the tweaking that we are doing will increase the output also.

India Cements Limited
May 20, 2024

Page 3 of 9

We are installing a vertical roller mill at Sankari , which will substantially drop the cost of fly ash, because we can use wet fly ash , which is much cheaper, which is closer and use more and more of it. And the plant will become a million ton plant in no time.

We have some plans for the Raasi plant group, which will unfold as time goes on. But with the existing and the fact that we will be operating at closer to capacity, because of the availability of, we were constrained by, you can say, working capital which will not be the case in the years going and the period. So, therefore, we will out -turn a much higher quantity of cement . As a result of which , our earnings will be much better.

So, this is the broad outline I wanted to sketch to you. I am very happy to answer any questions that any of you may have. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. We have a question from the line of Rajesh Kumar Ravi from HDFC Securities. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: Sir, could you share the rupees per kilo cal costing in Q4 and the housekeeping numbers for revenue and EBITDA for shipping, wind and concrete?

Management: Th

e cost per Kcal for the qua rter was 1.95 and shipping turnover was 7.4 with EBITDA of 1.7 and RMC division was 27 crores with 2 .2 crores of EBITDA .

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: 2.24?

Management: Yes.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: And windmill? Wind?

Management: Windmill was very marginal, only 0.5 crores revenue and there was a negative EBITDA.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: How much did you say ? Revenue was how much?

Management: Only 0.5 crores .

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: Okay, 0.5 crores. And sir, this quarter we see that there is a significant improvement in balance sheet. You know , net debt has come off considerably if I look at the past few years. And s o, what is the plan in terms of non -core assets monetization in terms of asset sell -off? And secondly , how much is the profit you are looking at from the sale of Trinetra plant which you have done ,

which will be booked in Q1?
Management: Which plant?
India Cements Limited
May 20, 2024

Page 4 of 9

Management: We sold the Parli Grinding Unit , not Trinetra .
Management: We sold the grinding unit at Pa rli for 315 crores.
Management: As far as we are concerned , to the extent necessary , we will dispose of f assets. But we will not dispose additional assets just for the sake of disposing.
Rajesh Kumar Ravi: Parli unit, how much is the profit book ed, sir, net of taxes?
Management: That will come in this quarter . That is only in this quarter.
Rajesh Kumar Ravi: When you are saying that , you are not looking at immediate monetization of more land or any other assets curren tly?
Management: We are looking at selling some land with parcels which happens when you get the right price and th e right buyer will look at that as we have already stated in the policy.
Management: We have no fixed ideas on this. We are looking towards monetization. Depending on the price and the parcel of land , it will go.
Moderator: Thank you. We will take our next question from the line of Shouvik Chakraborty from D olat Capital. Please go ahead.
Shouvik Chakraborty: So, can you just share some color on the pricing scenario from the exit of March, maybe how much the prices have changed in your operating regions?
Management: See, post March, the exit price from March, the prices went up in April, in fact went up smartly . But then in May again we have seen some dilution, and it is across the South . So, it is not like it is associated to any states . It has come down. So, maybe the current prices are slightly better than March exit price, but not very greatly higher.
So, this is the position today, but you know prices keep changing . Looks like in June again the prices will go up. So, this is what we expect . I think as the election thing gets over, I think the prices will go up in June is what we are expecting. It will be a yo -yo sort of a thing for this quarter. It went up , it came down and is again likely to go up.
Shouvik Chakraborty: Also , can you just share the trade numbers, I mean, trade mix for this quarter?
Management: You want the percentage?
Shouvik Chakraborty: Yes.
India Cements Limited
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Management: Yes, we have sold around 57% in trade, balance in non -trade.
Moderator: Thank you. We have our next question from the line of Navin Sahadeo from IC ICI Securities . Please go ahead.
Navin Sahadeo: Sir, I had one question regarding the CAPEX . So, how much do we pencil in towards CAPEX in FY '25 and '26 given the overall efficiency enhancement works that the company is likely to undertake? Just wanted to understand potential benefits of that and how much CAPEX are we budgeting for that?
Management: You see, actually the total amount is about 700 crores, 750 , out of which 300 will go for working capital . Balance will go for CAPEX .
Management: So, j ust to explain what MD mentioned , CAPEX plan is about 500 . That 500 crores will go towards ef
ficiency improvement CAPEX and normal routine CAPEX will be about 100 crores
here, which is what we have been spending all the way through . So, the next two years you can take approximately 700 crores is the total CAPEX .
Navin Sahadeo: Just to confirm, next two years, CAPEX of roughly 700 crores with roughly 350 each year, right?
Management: No, 500 crores towards efficiency improvement CAPEX , like waste heat recovery system in Chilamakuru or VRM in Sankari and so on and so forth. And 200 will be normal . 100 crores per annum is our normal CAPEX , routine CAPEX .
Navin Sahadeo: Yes, exactly. So, broadly, total outflow will be 700. We can fit between 300 and 350 each year, right?
Management: Need n ot necessarily. We are now looking to launch our modernization CAPEX as soon as possible. Once that happens, then most of the money will be s pent this year. Next year will be restricted to the balance spending and routine CAPEX .
Navin Sahadeo: So, out of this 500 crore efficiency CAPEX , you are saying there is a chance that FY '25 may see a front loading of it and '26 may see some part of that, but your maintenance CAPEX of 100 crore each year, roughly like that, right?
Management: Exactly like that .
Moderator: Thank you. We have a question from the line of Shouvik Chakraborty from D olat Capital. Please go ahead.

Shouvik Chakraborty: So, just wanted to get, could not hear the number for the windmill EBITDA. I mean, you said 0.5 crore was the revenue and how much was the EBITDA?

India Cements Limited

May 20, 2024

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Management: Negative of 1. Negative EBITDA of 1 crore .

Moderator: Thank you. We have a next question from the line of Rajesh Kumar Ravi from HDFC Securities.

Please go ahead.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: Sir, could you please spell out this 500 crore improvement CAPEX that you are doing? What all things would be achieved in this?

Management: It is waste heat recovery plant in Chilamakuru, cooler upgrade in some of the plants.

Sankarnagar will have MM D crusher. Dalavoi will have a cooler and burner. Banswara will have a cooler and a burner. Cement mill upgrade at Sankari Durg and VRM at Sankari Durg.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: And this WHR is what size?

Management: 8 Megawatts.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: 8 Megawatts. And recently we completed one upgradation of a mill, right?

Management: '23-'24.

Management: Sankarnagar VRM got capitalized last year.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: So, was there any capacity increase because of that?

Management: No capacity increases . It was a replacement CAPEX of old cement mills.

Management: And also efficiency improvement . That's all.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: And what sort of cost reduction you are looking at through these efforts and the investments of 500 crore that you are making and by when these would start reflecting in numbers?

Management: This is, some of the projects will get over in 6 to 8 months . Some projects will take up to 12 to 15 months. It all depends on the.... . So, generally for plant by plant we can say Sankarnagar we are looking at around Rs. 300 sort of a reduction because the mines are also opening up post-election . Same way Sankari will have a reduction of around Rs. 100 to Rs. 120.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: This is on per plant; on individual plant basis you are looking at?

Management: For each plant, the improvement will be for that plant specific. Banswara will have a volume increase as well as some reduction in cost. Each one will have an advantage of either the volume going up at higher EBITDA, higher margins are there or cost reduction or both. This is how it will be.

India Cements Limited

May 20, 2024

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Rajesh Kumar Ravi: So, once you have completed this , the next 15 months , on a company level , what is the savings you are looking at?

Management: Rs. 150 to Rs. 175 per ton. That is what we are targeting.

Management: Rs. 150 to Rs. 175 per ton. That is what we are targeting.

Rajesh Kumar Ravi: And in FY '24, what sort of savings you have achieved from various operating efficiency programs which are underway?

Management: FY '24, we did not carry out any efficiency programs. Basically BCG came in and based on their suggestions in three of the plants we have achieved a savings of about Rs. 184 per ton.

Management: For those plants .

Management: Only three plants.

Moderator: Thank you. We will take a last question from the line of Prateek Kumar from Jefferies. Please go ahead.

Prateek Kumar: My first question is on regional demand. We have like 12% volume decline year -on-year for ourselves during the quarter. What was the region growth during the quarter and how is it trending for the first quarter '25?

Management: See, the demand was not bad. Demand was okay though it declined in the last quarter. We lost volume because of our constraints on working capital. Otherwise , the industry has grown most of it on double digits and the last quarter a little less , around 7%, 8% was the growth. But if you look at the year as a whole , it should be close to 9 % to 10% at least growth for the South . I am talking about South market . The country as a whole also is close to 10%, but definitely South is 10%. But we lost mainly because of the working capital constraints.

Prateek Kumar: And is it getting better in the first quarter , FY '25 for yourself and the industry ?

Management: The volume so far has been very subdued from various reasons, including election being one of the points. So , we expect it to be improving only from post June onwards only. And the 1st April and May, the demand has not been very great, because it may be flatish kind of working.

Prateek Kumar: The industry would be lower like sharply in first quarter year -on-year?

Management: I couldn't get you. Can you repeat the question?

Prateek Kumar: The industry growth will be down sharply and negative year -on-year for first quarter FY '25?

Management: First two months it may be flat is my guess. It is a pure guess I am making. It may be flat.

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Moderator: Thank you. I now hand over the conference to Mr. Vaibhav Agarwal for closing comments. Over to you.

Vaibhav Agarwal: Thank you , Yashashree. Sir, I had a question. Sir, I just wanted to know the basic, firstly the operational impact about selling the Parli Grinding Unit on our operating numbers and volumes in terms of what kind of EBITDA it was making and what was the future impact on this part of the brand?

Management: Vaibhav, Parli was not making much of EBITDA for us. That is the reason we thought of disposing it off. And what we have planned is to add up the grinding capacity in Malkapur , which gives us a better contribution. So, that is what we have realized because our market was more towards Sholapur to the Bombay area. We were not so strong in that area. So , it didn't make sense for us to continue with the capacity , especially with the sale tax benefit gone. So , that is why we thought of disposing this project.

Vaibhav Agarwal: So, sir, for the current year like FY '24, we have made about a volume of 9.5, 9.46 around. And so with the sale of this grinding unit, do we expect to kind of achieve a 10 million volume for FY '25 or your internal targets?

Management: Our plan is to do more volume because we are still at 61% is the utilization only. So , we have a headroom of almost 40% on existing plant. So, it is actually, as I said, the volumes will not be lost because we will add that capacity in Malkapur itself.

Vaibhav Agarwal: And sir, one last question would be, I just wanted to understand the broad management thought process since Parli was a core asset for us and we have all been making, we maintain that we will be looking to sell non -core assets to fund the working capital requirement

or address the

balance sheet issues , but this time this was a sale of a core asset. So, in going forward, if you identify new plants which are probably not making good EBITDA or good profitability in line to Parli, would we be looking to sell or what?

Management: We are not looking at selling plants . We are looking at selling waste land.

Vaibhav Agarwal: Exactly. So, that's what I was asking. So, any more plants which potentially in the future we will consider, or we look at the non -core only from here on to if there is any sale?

Management: Yes, only non -core.

Vaibhav Agarwal: Thanks a lot, sir. That addresses the question. Thank you very much , sir. On behalf of PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited , we would like to thank you for the call and many thanks for participants joining the call. Yashashree, you may now conclude the call. Thank you.

India Cements Limited
May 20, 2024

Page 9 of 9

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of PhillipCapital (India) Private Limited , that concludes the conference call. Thank you for joining us , and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2025

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: Jul 2025

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: Oct 2025

E: investor@indiacements.co.in

SH/ 27.10 .2025

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Exchange Plaza , 5th Floor ,
Plot No.C/1 , G Block
Bandra -Kurla Complex
Bandra (E)
MUMBAI 400 051.

Scrip Code : 530005 Scrip Code : INDIACEM

Dear Sirs,

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 - Transcript of Earnings Call
In continuation to our letter dated 18th October 2025, please find enclosed the transcript of the Earnings Call held on 18th October 2025 on the unaudited financial results for the quarter and half -year ended 30th September 2025.
The same is available on the website of the Company i.e.
www.indiacements.co.in.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully,
for THE INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED

COMPANY SECRETARY

Encl.: As above

UltraTech Cement Limited
Registered Office : Ahura Centre, B – Wing, 2nd Floor, Mahakali Caves Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai 400 093, India
T: +91 22 6691 7800 / 2926 7800 I F: +91 22 6692 8109 I W: www.ultratechcement.com/www.adityabirla.com I CIN : L26940MH2000PLC128420

27th October , 2025

BSE Limited

Corporate Relationship Department

Scrip Code: 532538 The National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Listing Department

Scrip Code: ULTRACEMCO

Sub: Transcript of Q 2 FY26 Earnings Call of UltraTech Cement Limited ("the Company")

De

ar Sirs ,

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n terms of Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, please find attached transcript of the Q2 FY26 Earnings Call conducted after the meeting of the Board of Directors of the Company held on 18th October , 2025, for your information and record.

The s

ame is also available on the website of the Company viz. www.ultratechcement.com .

Y

ours faithfully,

For UltraTech Cement Limited

Sanjeeb Kumar Chatterjee
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Luxembourg Stock Exchange
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US90403YAA73 and USY9048BAA18
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KUMAR CHATTERJEE Digitally signed by
SANJEEB KUMAR CHATTERJEE Date: 2025.10.27 10:41:14 +05'30'
Page 1 of 12

“Ultra Tech Cement Limited
Q2 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call ”
October 18 , 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. KAILASH C. JHANWAR – MANAGING DIRECTOR
MR. ATUL DAGA – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

UltraTech Cement Limited
October 18 , 2025

Page 2 of 12

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, Good day, and welcome to the UltraTech Cement Limited Q2 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Atul Daga, Chief Financial Officer. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Atul Daga: Thank you. Good evening, everyone, and welcome to the earnings call of UltraTech Cement for the quarter ended September '25. I realize it is a Saturday, and for those who are attending the call, a sincere thanks for taking time out on your weekend.

Let me straight jump into the nitty -gritties. Firstly, demand. I think it's very important to note that we have sold more than 31 million tons of cement this quarter , when rain gods have been in full fury till almost a few days ago. On ground, things are looking up, looking better for premium cement all the more. We will talk about it in a bit.

UltraTech is a very large company , we operate almost 75 physical locations, 400 -plus RMC plants. And in that phase of rapid growth, the sales volume growth will be a little complex to understand for 3 or 4 quarters. If we were to look at our sales volumes without ICL and Kesoram in the base for the last year because we were not managing them, we have grown 22.3%. Without considering India Cements in our base for the last quarter , we have recorded a growth of 9.6%. With both ICL and Kesoram Cement assets in the base, we have grown about 6.8%. India Cements has already declared its results yesterday with a growth of 6%.

Most important points to note is UltraTech as a brand has grown about 13.2% this quarter Y -o- Y. That is real hard number. Rural markets are also delivering a growth of 13%, and we believe that the industry will achieve a growth of a round 10% in the rural markets.

We have been rapidly converting India Cements and Kesoram brands into UltraTech with a sharp focus on improving the quality of the product manufactured at the acquired plant locations.

The results are quite exciting. As I mentioned, UltraTech, as a brand, has grown 13.2%, thanks to the rapid conversion of output generated from the acquired assets.

Let's talk about GST. GST, whilst there's no impact on profitability, an important benefit of GST 2 is a reduction in Clean Energy Cess levy on coal. We believe this will be in the long-term interest of UltraTech. We balance our fuel portfolio with a mix of coal and pet coke. The strategy has always helped manage our risk. This quarter, with slightly higher coal consumption, the ratio is skewed in favor of coal at about 48% and pet coke being about 44%. This quarter, our fuel costs are higher than last quarter, increasing to INR1.8 per Kcal as compared to INR1.78 per Kcal, it's a mix of coal and pet coke essentially and timing.

The next few quarters will be a mix of our existing high-performance assets of 166.76 million tons and the acquired assets, which, are ramping up rapidly, namely Kesoram Cement assets, 10.75 million tons and India Cements, 14.75 million tons.

UltraTech Cement Limited

October 18, 2025

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Our existing operating assets 166.76 million tons of capacity have delivered an EBITDA per metric ton of INR966. India Cements reported its performance yesterday, delivering INR386 per metric ton and Kesoram assets this quarter were at INR755.

For your reference, India Cement's brand conversion has already happened 31%, and Kesoram has already converted 55% at the end of this quarter. This will clearly give you a perspective of how the overall average numbers will p

an out when full brand conversion will be completed.

We are expecting to complete the brand transition for these acquired assets, not later than June '26.

There have been some specific cost items one-off slightly higher, which have had a dampening effect on our performance. First one, maintenance costs, you will be shocked to know that we operate almost 56 kilns across the country in UltraTech's balance sheet. And if you were to take into account India Cements' kilns also, a total number of 65 kilns are being operated by us. In UltraTech, out of the 56 kilns, we had 617 kiln days shutdown as compared to 207 kiln days last quarter or 511 kiln days last year for the same period. This is one of the reasons why our fixed costs are slightly higher. When we do an internal calculation, it's about an impact of INR100 per ton. Second one was the advertising cost, during this quarter, our advertising efforts had been taken up. We spent INR50 crores higher than the last quarter, resulting into an impact of about INR15 per ton. Third item was staff costs, which were again slightly higher in this quarter and all employees obviously enjoy this quarter because the increments and the annual bonus payments are made in the July-September period. Quarter-on-quarter, additional cost of INR94 crores were incurred, but you don't have to worry as this impact will come down next quarter by INR30-35 crores. The per ton impact is roughly INR25 per ton. Operating leverage impact due to lower Q-o-Q sales volume is close to INR70 per ton. If I count all these items, then there is a delta impact of anywhere around INR200 per ton. But that doesn't mean that these costs will not exist in the next quarter. There will be some element of cost, but not such a high impact.

Capex. Our expansion plans are going on full swing, and we will complete or exit this financial year with 200 million tons of capacity under our belt. Projects like Vadhavan Port, Amravati, development around the new Mumbai Airport, data centers coming up in the country, urban real estate, Google committing \$15 billion to build its AI hub in Andhra. All such mega projects are very positive for cement industry for consistent growth demand. And GST 2 will definitely boost demand for premium cement because some people will be able to buy their aspirational brands due to a reduction in the cost of purchase.

You would have also seen our next phase of growth. I have mentioned it in the past. After completing our consolidation in the Southern markets in fiscal '25, we have focused our guns on North and West. With an intent to further strengthen our position in these markets, we are embarking on the next phase of our growth with 22.8 million tons of incremental capacity, which is a mix of largely brownfield and some greenfield expansions. Out of these 22.8 million tons, 18 million tons is focused on the Northern markets and 4.8 million tons for the Western markets.

A very important point for you to note is we will always be fully invested in clinker. At the end of this expansion, we will be reaching 148 million tons of clinker capacity with a clinker conversion factor reaching close to 1.6x. This expansion also will be funded largely by internal

UltraTech Cement Limited

October 18, 2025

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accruals. There might be some temporary borrowings that will be done but by the time we complete our expansion, we will be again less than 0.7x net debt EBITDA.

Cables and wires business. The business is on track to launch production in Q3 CY '26. Land and buildings have been secured, long lead machinery items have been placed. We expect delivery to start from January '26, and the plant should get commissioned in time for Q3 production launch. Key managerial people have also started onboarding. I touched upon ICL and Kesoram assets. As I mentioned, India Cements brand transition has been completed up to 31% of the

air sales as UltraTech and it will cross the 40% mark by

December quarter and then further up; thereby, helping us realize the benefits of synergy in the books of India Cements on a very rapid pace. As a post-balance sheet event in India Cements, we have exited the coal assets held in Indonesia and the cash flows that will be realized from the sale of these assets will help reduce their debt.

Another important point to highlight about India Cements is the capex program of INR1,592 crores, which has been initiated for debottlenecking of a small capacity 21-megawatts of WHRS, 192-megawatts of renewable energy and other efficiency improvement programs. Over and above that, we are expanding the capacity at Chennai and Rajasthan plants with 2.4 million tons at a cost of INR422 crores. These are high-performing markets and the investment will yield an IRR of upwards of 20%.

We acquired India Cements with a capacity of 14.45 million tons; within no time, there was a debottlenecking done. And further brownfield expansions that I've just mentioned, will take us to a capacity of 17.55 million tons. We will be able to fund these investments with internal accruals and a mix of debt. However, by the time we complete the expansion, which is January March 28 or by the time the expansions are fully operational, the ICL assets will start generating EBITDA per ton of INR1,000 and a net debt EBITDA of around 0.5x.

Kesoram assets have also streamlined and a capex of around INR500 crores is in progress for WHRS and other efficiency improvements. The brand transition program, as I mentioned earlier, has already been completed to about 55% of its output, and we shall complete the rest of the program by the end of June '26.

Another important point, which I must leave with you, is our retail footprint. We have a presence with almost 5,000 stores in the country, these retail stores, what we call the UBS stores, sold 21% of our total sales this quarter, and also support the dreams of many individual homebuilders to procure other materials required for building a house.

RMC is another important aspect of our business. We have crossed almost 400 plants in the country. Today, RMC has become about 4% of cement volumes for us.

For some of you, the dessert is the most important in terms of EBITDA per ton, but at UltraTech, this quarter has been a wholesome meal.

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Thank you. And before taking questions, we wish you all a very happy Diwali. Over to you for questions, please.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin with the question and answer session. Our first question comes from the line of Amit Murarka from Axis Capital.

Amit Murarka: Just on this expansion plan that you've announced. So, like after this, I just wanted to know like how much more scope is there given that this is just focused on North and West. And I'm guessing there is scope even in East, South, those markets as well. So, what is the additional scope for brownfield expansion that exists in the portfolio?

Atul Daga: Amit, so we are now sticking our program to reach about 240 - 245 million tons, which will get completed by fiscal '29. There is definitely scope for 20 - 25 million tons more. I'm talking about beyond '29, '30, '31 and in those times, there will be further possibilities. There will be possibilities of greenfield clinker-based units also since we continuously keep acquiring mining rights, and land acquisition is an ongoing process. So, it's not only brownfield, but we'll also have greenfield expansions depending upon the market appetite, which we believe will be very high.

Amit Murarka: Understood. And also, while we spelled out the other expenses, reasons for the other expenses jump, even raw material has moved up, is there some one-off even in that?

Atul Daga: There's no one-off. There might be some purchase price

impact, other than there's no one-off.

Amit Murarka: And out of the INR200 per ton, which you summed up under various items, how much of it will go away essentially in Q3, if you could just give some number on that?

Atul Daga: So, maintenance will come down. At least ballpark INR100 will come down.

Amit Murarka: Right, right. And just lastly, on the fuel cost, we have seen pet coke move up while you have only 44%, but will net fuel cost go up given that there is coal compensation cess positive benefit as well?

Atul Daga: So, we'll have a bigger benefit because UltraTech consumes higher amount of coal as compared to rest of the industry, so that will also be a benefit to us. And now it is always possible that the flavor of pet coke starts going down and coal is becoming more important.

Amit Murarka: Sure. So on a net basis, basically, fuel cost may not go up too much for you?

Atul Daga: So it will not go up. All the spot purchases is the only thing, which could move up or down. But in our overall scheme of things, we will not have any inflation in fuel costs.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Indrajit Agarwal from CLSA.

Indrajit Agarwal: Two questions. First, congratulations on such low capex per ton on the next leg of expansion.

Now keeping that in mind and the cost-saving initiatives across the industry, how do you see the

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pricing environment or the intensity of taking prices up in the medium term among the players panning out?

Atul Daga: Thank you, Indrajit, for noticing that. Well, as far as the efficiency improvement program is concerned, I think UltraTech is the only company, which has demonstrated item-by-item actual delivery of efficiency improvement. Capex cost, I don't know whether anybody else can deliver this kind of an efficiency in capex cost. So, it remains to be seen. Third point you mentioned about pricing. Pricing is not determined by capex cost or efficiency improvement. Pricing, I will repeat again, it's always been demand. If demand is good, there is always an opportunity for improvement in prices. If there are cost inflation pressures on, let's say, just now when we discussed about fuel costs, in case fuel costs go through the roof or any other costs go through the roof, if the industry, if we can't absorb it, it will get definitely passed on. Pricing decisions will not be taken because of lower capex cost.

Indrajit Agarwal: Sure. This is helpful. Secondly, on industry demand, on your best estimate, how was the demand in second quarter? And do you think the earlier guidance of 6% to 7% industry growth for the full year is achievable?

Atul Daga: I think so, yes, it is definitely happening. My confidence is going up higher if I look at my own volume growth. And as far as industry growth is concerned, it has to be somewhere around 4.5% to 5% for this quarter.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Pinakin Parekh from HSBC.

Pinakin Parekh: Sir, my first question is on the commissioning time line for the expansions. It says FY '28 onwards. So, will it get bunched up in FY '28, or will it be spread over '28, '29, '30?

Atul Daga: Not bunched up. It would be mostly evenly spread out. We will come out with detailed schedule in the next quarter, but it's not getting bunched up.

Pinakin Parekh: Sure. And sir, secondly, just more granular color on how does the company see demand between government capex and individual homebuyers? Because from a pricing point of view, for the trade segment, we need the individual homebuyer segment demand to pick up. So as per you, where do you see stronger demand over the second half of the year?

Atul Daga: I think the rural markets, as I talked about it, we have seen about 13% growth in rural markets, which is a very positive point. So IHB segment will continue to drive demand. And also, we are

re

seeing continuous announcements of new Infra projects, which will help the overall demand sentiment. Jhanwar Ji, would like to add something.

Kailash Jhanwar: Yes. So very good afternoon to all of you. So, I think, Atul has said rightly, the housing sector would be the key driver for the growth and particularly the rural housing, the demand has been good and with the good monsoon actually this year and the revision in the MSP price and kind of thing, I think the rural India is likely to do very well. On the urban side, obviously, with the change in the income tax rates, personal income tax rates, softening of interest, there are good green shoots and the urban demand is also likely to move further.

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Coming on the Infra side, I think, as Atul said, I think the Infra is now likely to fire on all fronts right from the road, rail, aviation and the port side actually because in the recent few months or the few days, there are a lot of announcements actually in terms of building new highways, widening of the highways and the metro, port. And now if the Sagarmala projects pick up, then further it will provide boost to the demand.

And commercial side, I think, again, that's likely to be the good story with the GCC. Recently, a few days back, there is an announcement on the big data center, Google. So, I think we believe, hopefully, demand side do well.

Atul Daga: So, Pinakin, it's not about a quarter. I think if you are looking at a longer term, and we had put

out one chart on how we see the long-term growth also, it's 7%, 8% CAGR growth. I'm very confident that this is going to happen in the country.

Just imagine, if you were to delve a little bit more in Google's investment of \$15 billion over a period of 5 years. It's not just a data center, but there'll be employees and their housing and the related schools, hospitals, blah, blah, blah, everything will be coming up. So, this is one -off. Vadhavan Port, INR76,000 crore's project, 300 million ton cargo handling capability. The project will go on for 5 - 6 years or even more. But that will change the fortunes of entire Western market.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Sumangal Nevatia from Kotak Securities.

Sumangal Nevatia: Firstly, I appreciate all the detailing on the expansion plans and also a lot of more disclosures in the regular quarterly presentation. Sir, my first question is on the North market. You shared in the presentation that last couple of years, the peak utilization has been approaching 90%. Any thoughts on how are we looking at over the next 4 to 5 years, given a lot of peers, JK, Dalmia, JSW, all focusing on North in the next leg of expansion. So any analysis, which you can share on our estimates, is there a risk of an oversupply situation gradually building in North given the supply?

Atul Daga: No, Sumangal, no, I don't think so. And I think the more important from UltraTech's point of view is, we have always grown better than the rest of the industry at a pace higher than the industry. We are confident that our capacity share, which today stands at 28% will go up to 32%-33%, and there's no stopping us there. So UltraTech will continue to gain market share.

UltraTech does not see any risk in being able to sell more volumes of cement.

Kailash Jhanwar: Yes. To further add upon, I think, also it is an overall function if you talk about the capacity utilization where your plants are located actually. Once we'll share you the more details in the next quarterly discussions actually based on our footprint and the location, I think UltraTech would be stand out in terms of the...

Atul Daga: Yes, I didn't want to say it, Sumangal, but deserts are desserts and city is a city. So, we can discuss later offline, yes.

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Sumangal Neva

tia: Okay. So on the green power mix, we've reached 42%. One is over the next couple of years, where do we settle at? So just want to understand, incrementally, any thumb rule we can kind of use as to what cost is in every percentage increase or something like that to estimate the cost savings?

Atul Daga: We will reach about 65% of green power by the end of our current phase of growth. And I've already started disclosing my cost mix. So, when you are reaching 65%, thermal power will come down. You can do an estimation from there.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. And just one last thing. In the opening remarks, sir, you alluded to some sort of a premiumization benefit out of GST. Can you explain what's the thought there?

Atul Daga: So what I believe is everybody has an aspiration, not only for cement, for any other asset. Now if that particular product comes within my striking distance, which I was deferring or not going that part. Now if that asset is within my striking distance, I would definitely want to use that asset.

Now let's talk about cement. Cement, when a person is building his house, which is once in a lifetime, if that person was not able to buy UltraTech as a premium product, roughly INR30 impact has happened favorably in the hands of the end consumer. The affordability was INR360.

There are 2 ways. The person who was wanting to buy at INR360 either will switch down to INR330 for a category B brand or might be incentivized to buy a premium brand at INR360.

That's premiumization.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Prateek Kumar from Jefferies.

Prateek Kumar: I have a couple of questions. Firstly, on premium cement, how do you think the premium segment pricing can pan out over the next 12 months versus the regular product for yourself or for market?

Atul Daga: It again depends upon demand. Prateek, if demand is robust and there's a cost pressure also, then obviously, there's an opportunity to push it into prices.

Prateek Kumar: And where do you envisage your 33% premium mix going to over the next 12 to 18 months?

Atul Daga: I don't have a number immediately, Prateek, take it offline. I don't want to give an ad hoc answer. We can discuss on Monday. I'll share some more highlights.

Prateek Kumar: Sure. You have reported like like -for-like growth of 7% for the overall consol operations. How is that split in region-wise? And also, your total 71% capacity utilization for first half, how would that be region-wise?

Atul Daga: So if I look at regional capacity utilization, North and, in fact, South are in the 70s and West is in the high 60s and Central and East is low 60s.

Prateek Kumar: And what about the volume growth region -wise?
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Atul Daga: Volume growth region -wise. I think the capacity utilization should be a good parameter for you. I don't have immediately the regional growth numbers.

Prateek Kumar: Sure, no problem. One last question on your expansion into Northern markets. So , while some of the capacity appears to be in Central, you are allocating all those capacity to North, like we generally...

Atul Daga: I was expecting somebody to ask this question. For us, we split UP and MP into UP East, UP West and MP East and MP West. The Western parts of MP and UP are more North -centric. Because let's take Vikram Cement, which is in Madhya Pradesh, but it is an hour away and you're into Rajasthan. So that is part of our Rajasthan or Northern markets as compared to calling it a Central market. Similarly, Dhar is very suitable for servicing Northern markets. Dadri, which is sitting in Delhi is in UP, but it serves Northern markets. So that is why we look at UP West and MP West in our internal scheme of things as Northern markets. So these, while even if you want to classify them as Central areas, but the output or their distribution is in the Northern markets

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Rashi from Citi.

Rashi: Just a quick question on Kesoram. The EBITDA per ton that you've given is at INR755, and I understand the first quarter was about INR1,000. So , this entire decline, I mean, barring the realization has got to do with all these maintenance?

Atul Daga: Yes, shutdowns, maintenance, that's it.

Rashi: But was there any offsetting impact with the improvement in the rebranding to UltraTech?

Atul Daga: Obviously, because I have at least INR15 to INR20 delta on pricing between UltraTech and Kesoram old brands. There is an advantage.

Rashi: I'm just trying to understand how we think about Kesoram going forward from here.

Atul Daga: So my sense is December, I should be back to INR1,000. And once we are completing our brand transition in Kesoram, it should be operating at -- because again, the Kesoram asset while it's in South, but services Mumbai market. The 9-million -ton plant, Sedam plant is closer to the Maharashtra market, so it should enjoy the profitability of the Western markets. Once WHRS and everything is implemented, we will be crossing INR1,000, INR1,100, INR1,200 mark by the end of June '26.

Rashi: Got it. And just a bookkeeping question, sir, India EBITDA per ton, which was about INR1,230 in 1Q, is it working out about INR900 in this quarter on a blended basis?

Atul Daga: INR966.

Rashi: India, all in, as in including Kesoram and India Cements?

Atul Daga: That includes India Cements. Also , India Cements is INR386 a ton.

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Rashi: So INR966 includes India Cements.

Atul Daga: Then I think you would look at INR914, if that is the number you are looking at.

Rashi: Okay. Got it. And from like spot pricing versus what you had in the second quarter, is it largely stable?

Atul Daga: Pricing in cement prices, coal prices?

Rashi: Cement, cement prices.

Atul Daga: I thought you're asking about cement bag prices. So no, prices are stable.

Rashi: Okay. Do you see an improvement in the cost, the INR100 reversal that you're talking about, offset by higher pet coke prices going forward?

Atul Daga: As I also mentioned, our fuel prices are not going up because we will also have the advantage of coal sales getting knocked off and the maximum benefit without a doubt will be to UltraTech.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Pathanjali Srinivasan from Sundaram Mutual Fund.

Pathanjali Srinivasan: Congrats on a good set of numbers. Firstly, I'd like to thank you for giving such a good presentation with this like very good amount of transparency in reporting in terms of numbers with organic and inorganic. It really gives us a good amount of confidence in what you're doing.

I have a few questions. First question is this pricing actions post GST, is there any kind of a window or time line for which we're not allowed to increase prices?

Atul Daga: No, there is nothing like that, but prices will go up if there is pressure on cost, if there is a huge amount of demand or if there's a shortage of material, then prices go up. There's no prescription around that.

Pathanjali Srinivasan: Okay, sir. And like just on a quarter -on-quarter, like we have seen a small fall in prices in terms of realization. What are the regions where you would say the impact of this is more?

Atul Daga: So I would say quarter -on-quarter, Central was the most impacted.

Pathanjali Srinivasan: Okay. And when we mentioned about margin profile, what is the margin profile difference be for regular cement versus premium, sir? Because you're saying that premiumization could be something that could play out. I just wanted to figure out what would be the difference?

Atul Daga: But it is very difficult to do -- it becomes a theoretical calculation. So lot of overhead allocation will be done. If we were just doing the contribution

analysis, that is different, but EBITDA

analysis is very theoretical. So, we don't do that.

Pathanjali Srinivasan: Okay. Got it, sir. Sir, and last question is you had mentioned about like some plants have been dropped in the presentation, and we've also done a little bit of a rejig there. So, is this more of a strategic thing? Or is there any other reason why we've done this?

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Atul Daga: Strategic. Because when we had started off on that expansion plan, India Cements was not acquired, and we were doing, let's say, a bulk terminal in Chennai. Now we have the grinding unit in Chennai. So, on the contrary, we have decided to increase the capacity of Chennai grinding unit of India Cements and drop our investment in the bulk terminal in Chennai. Now because we are dropping the bulk terminal, the corresponding clinker, which was coming up in Tadipatri, which is Andhra Pradesh, which was going to serve this location, we have dropped the grinding capacity in Tadipatri unit. So what should I say, balancing, no other compulsions.

Pathanjali Srinivasan: So in West Bengal, we have dropped a grinding unit I think to some 1 million tons. Any specific thing there?

Atul Daga: Because, again, that was rebalancing. We dropped Kharagpur and we have increased our presence in Dankuni. So it's again, locational advantages that we had, net logistics advantage that we could get. That's how we have tried to optimize our capex.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Sanjeev Kumar Singh from Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

Sanjeev Kumar Singh: Our current CC ratio is around 1.48x. And when we gave the clinker capacity addition schedule, we said that it's based on 1.56x of CC ratio. So, should we assume that gradually we want to increase our clinker conversion ratio to around 1.55 x, 1.56x over the next few years? And if we do that, what will be the cost advantages, which we would see?

Atul Daga: So, as I mentioned, we will actually reach 1.59 to 1.6 post this expansion, obviously, which means a higher amount of blending will take place. And the current expansion program itself, we had said we will reach 1.54. So obviously, we are focusing on increasing our blending, which helps our sustainability efforts also, and it is cost advantageous as well.

Just a housekeeping question because of the previous question, which was raised, I think there's a small error in my presentation when we have talked about dropping off 3 assets, there were a couple of assets, which we rebalanced, for example, Dankuni, which was not part of our plan.

So instead of Kharagpur, we have gone into Dankuni.

Sanjeev Kumar Singh: Secondly, sir, when there has been a drop in or reduction in green energy sales, but we believe that at the same time, there has been some increase in overall GST on coal from 5% to 18%. So, considering that, what kind of cost benefit we would see if considering both these numbers?

Atul Daga: GST increase in coal is input tax credit does not impact us. Like when GST on cement has gone down, it does not impact the profitability. Similarly, GST changes in coal does not impact the profitability; however, Cess, which was not allowed as an input, it's a cost, that going down is directly advantageous.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Rajesh Ravi from HDFC Securities.

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Rajesh Ravi: Sir, my question pertains to this clinker expansion, which you are doing. Dala voi IU, you have mentioned, Tamil Nadu, there is a brownfield expansion of 0.4 million tons in the India Cements.

Is there any clinker expansion also expected at that plant?

Atul Daga: That's a grinding capacity. India Cements, no, there's no further clinker capacity. But clinker we have enough available in the region to service it.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay. An

d this 22 million tons, your capex cost is less than INR500 crores per ton. So in this, how much is the clinker capacity cumulatively that you're planning to add?

Atul Daga: Total about 15.68 million tons. So, 8.04 are 2 specific plants and there are debottlenecking across the regions.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay. That is great. And sir, what would be the total capex number for next 2 years on the ongoing projects?

Atul Daga: I will have about INR10,000 crores minimum per year, outgo.

Rajesh Ravi: Okay, INR10,000 crores. And lastly, you mentioned earlier in the call, due to higher maintenance and advertisement cost in Q2, on a per ton basis, how much of these costs will get reversed in Q3?

Atul Daga: Give or take INR100 per ton.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we will take this as our last question for today. On behalf of UltraTech Cement Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Atul Daga: Thank you.

Disclaimer - The transcript has been edited for language and grammar; it however may not be a verbatim representation of the call.

Call: Jan 2026

E: investor@indiacements.co.in

SH/ 30.01.2026

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Scrip Code : 530005 Scrip Code : INDIACEM

Dear Sirs,

Sub.: Disclosure under Regulation 30 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 - Transcript of Earnings Call
In continuation to our letter dated 24th January 2026, please find enclosed the transcript of the Earnings Call held on 24th January 2026 on the unaudited financial results for the quarter and nine months ended 31st December 2025.
The same is available on the website of the Company i.e.
www.indiacements.co.in.

Thanking you,
Yours faithfully,
for THE INDIA CEMENTS LIMITED

COMPANY SECRETARY

Encl.: As above

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30th January, 2026

BSE Limited
Corporate Relationship Department
Scrip Code: 532538 The National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Listing Department
Scrip Code: ULTRACEMCO
Sub: Transcript of Q3 FY26 Earnings Call of UltraTech Cement Limited ("the Company")

Dear Sirs,

In terms of Regulation 30 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, please find attached transcript of the Q3 FY26 Earnings Call conducted after the meeting of the Board of Directors of the Company held on 24th January, 2026, for your information and record.
The same is also available on the website of the Company viz. www.ultratechcement.com .

Your
s faithfully,
For UltraTech Cement Limited

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Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call "

January 24, 2026

MANAGEMENT : M R. KAILASH C. J HANWAR –MANAGING DIRECTOR

MR. ATUL DAGA –CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

UltraTech Cement Limited

January 24, 2026

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good evening, and welcome to the UltraTech Cement Limited Q3 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call. This conference call may contain forward-looking statements about the company, which are based on the beliefs, opinions and expectations of the company as on date of this call. These statements are not a guarantee of future performance and involve risks and uncertainties that are difficult to predict.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchstone phone. Please note that this call is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Atul Daga, Business Head and CFO of UltraTech Cement Limited. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Atul Daga: Good evening, good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. Once again, a very warm welcome to yet another call on a Saturday evening for UltraTech for the third quarter results of fiscal'26. Before I begin, let me assure you, we will not make this a habit of spoiling your Saturdays, but this Saturday is worth spending time. Let me get on to the main core topic for discussion, which I have in mind today. Demand, that is the most important aspect for our business. Everything else becomes secondary and falls in line. And as we see the progress, Government's focus on infrastructure is translating into a robust pipeline of new projects nationwide with several marquee investments announced across every region, translating into solid demand. You must have all read about it in the media at different points in time, but let me put a perspective together in one place, region by region.

In the North, Punjab is taking extensive road development initiatives, spending about INR16,000 crores in its markets. New corridors have been announced in Delhi Metro for about INR12,000 crores. Uttar Pradesh is developing 1,575 kilometers metro network across major cities. Of course, that goes till 2047, it's a long horizon, multi-city infrastructure pipeline, indicating sustained demand and significant opportunity for cement. Highway projects, continued investment in road connectivity and logistics corridor across the state, like the 4-lane greenfield highway project between a place called Barabanki and Mustafabad.

Let's go to West India. Maharashtra is seeing a significant pipeline of large transport and mobility projects, signaling strong multiyear demand for cement and construction materials.

Mega projects like the Uttan-Virar Sea Link, about INR58,000 crores, Mumbai Metro expansions, Pune Metro multiple lines and road concretization in Mumbai. Center clearance of Pune-Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar Expressway highway spanning 245 kilometers with a particular focus on improving connectivity for rural communities, nearly 350 kilometers of state highways, 2,577 kilometers of rural roads, some rehabilitation initiatives. All of these are going to boost urban cement demand. Expressways and ring roads, Nashik-Vadhavan, Bhandara-Gadchiroli, et cetera, add to further boost for demand. Gujarat's 9 high-speed corridors covering about 800 kilometers are fast tracking connectivity and will add further. Cabinet has approved 2 major highway projects worth INR20,000 crores plus, Nashik-Solapur and one more, signaling continued momentum in India's integrated high-speed connectivity push under the PM Gati Shakti.

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Stepping down into South India. Bangalore is undergoing a major mobility transformation with the metro network set to expand from 96 kilometers to 175 kilometers by the end of December '27. Karnataka government has unveiled an urban infrastructure program which will

have longest 40-kilometre

r twin tunnel, a 41-kilometre double-decker metro, 110-kilometre elevated corridors. Center has approved INR10,000 crores expansion of 4 key highways

measuring about 273 kilometers, which will improve connectivity across Telangana. New Mangalore Port has announced capacity expansion to handle 100 million tons by 2047.

We can't forget the Eastern corridor. West Bengal has its own challenges, but is planning largest road initiatives, about INR8,487 crores program, 15,000 kilometers of rural roads, 5,019 kilometers of urban roads. All this just goes to say that India is developing very fast. Bihar is rolling out 3 major Ganga Road projects worth INR70,000 crores. Digha-Sherpur-Bihta-Koilwar (35 kilometers); Munger-Bariyarpur-Ghorghat-Sultanganj (42 kilometers), Sultanganj-Bhagalpur-Sabour (41 kilometers). So, I'm not advocating or speaking on behalf of NHAI, but this is what the story is surfacing.

Chhattisgarh, Center has approved 774 kilometers roads covering 2,000-plus kilometers under the PMGSY-IV. The state has already completed 8,753 roads and bridges are also under the same phase. Major rail expansion across Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, MP reflect the scale and diversity of investment underway.

To give you a perspective, roads and highways require approximately 350 to 900 metric tons per kilometer. With thousands of kilometers under construction or planned across all regions, this is going to be huge. Elevated metro requires 11,000 metric tons per kilometer. Underground metro requires anywhere between 17,000 to 19,000 metric tons per kilometer. Railways, 90 to 100 metric tons of cement, ports and airports go up to 50 kgs per square feet.

Housing, if I were to look at low-income housing programs, affordable housing and rural connectivity projects sustained steady demand. With a strong project pipeline, demand for cement will remain very continuous and as strong as possible. Infrastructure is seeing the next big wave of growth. What does that imply - more jobs, more demand for housing and social

infrastructure, i.e., schools, hospitals, commercial complexes, office and all. We are present across the country. Just to tell you about our RMC network is about 163 cities, which we are already covering and rapidly expanding. UltraTech is so sweetly positioned to meet the demand like nobody else. We are witnessing unprecedented growth in new avenues like data centers, GCC, renewable energy projects, you name it, and things are happening. As somebody just said, India has arrived. It's the market with a population of over 1.4 billion people, youngest working class and an opportunity across the land bank for development.

At UltraTech, we are fully geared up to capture these opportunities. Our approach remains rooted in disciplined execution, advancing our next phase of capacity expansion while ensuring every investment is backed by rigorous cost control and operational efficiency. In our fourth phase of expansion, large part of orders has already been placed, work has already commenced, and we will be on time. Importantly, we are funding all our growth through internal accruals, maintaining a prudent balance sheet and a healthy leverage profile.

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This, combined with our pan-India network and deepening retail footprint positions us to capture incremental demand at a very rapid pace while safeguarding our margins. You would have seen our leverage position this quarter end. On a consolidated basis, we are at 1.08x net debt EBITDA. I believe and I'm very confident that we'll reach the mark of 1x and be in 0.8, 0.9x net debt EBITDA by the end of this fiscal year.

Integration of recent acquisitions is progressing very well with rapid brand transition. Kesoram and India Cements are ahead of the initial plans, with brand conversion at Kesoram having reached 69% in December '25. And today, if we speak, it must have

crossed further. India

Cements has already crossed 58% at the end of December '25. For both these assets, we have begun our cost improvement capex program, which will result in benefits and will start reflecting in the P&L of January-March '27. At Kesoram, we have already spent INR263 crores, out of the commitment of about INR382 crores. At India Cements, we have committed already INR601 crores and spent INR144 crores on the program.

Talking about capex, the other initiative, cable and wires is progressing as per plan. About INR500 crores worth of orders have already been placed. We have spent INR197 crores. 30% of the planned team is already onboard, civil work has started, and we are on schedule to see the launch of our product in the October-December '26 quarter as was committed earlier.

Talking about our efficiency improvement program, we continue to deliver solid and measurable results. In fact, now I am very confident that we should be doing better than what we had committed. We shall give an exact quantification and financial impact with our annual results for the year. However, you would have noticed the lead distance has dropped to 363 kilometers.

The clinker conversion factor has improved to 1.49.

The most important factor, I believe, for us is to have a strong demand pipeline. And you will notice that January-March quarter, God willing, we will operate at more than 90% of our existing installed capacity, clearly demonstrating growth in the trade markets as well as non-trade markets. If the demand is good, everything else falls in line. Ultimately, it is about the bottom line where it comes from, doesn't really matter.

Quite often, everybody is focused on cement prices, which has remained subdued post GST change. Last week of September, October, November saw some softening prices. But with growing demand, we are witnessing improvement in prices in all segments across the country.

There have been cost increases in the cost of pet coke and coal, new labor code will have its own impact, rupee depreciation. All these will have an impact on the cement industry. And obviously, there is reason to pass on these cost escalations into prices.

We are very confident of a very bright future for the next quarter and after that quarter and after that and after that. That doesn't mean I'm restricting myself to a fiscal '27, but the story is far longer. As India embarks on the next decade of development, UltraTech is proud to play a pivotal role in building the nation's future. We remain confident that our strategic initiatives in building capacities across the country in critical market locations, coupled with sector's positive outlook, we will continue to deliver growth faster than the industry. And we welcome all of you to participate in our journey. Don't miss the bus. Thank you, and over to you for questions.

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Moderator: Thank you very much. The first question is from the line of Amit Kumar Murarka from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.

Amit Murarka: Congratulations, Mr. Daga, firstly, for a great result. I don't think anyone expected both volume and the margin beat actually, which is quite heartening to see. Just on pricing, wanted to get a sense from you, like there is a lot of industry capacity addition that is going to come through this year. What do you think industry's stance will be in this kind of a high expansion scenario?

Atul Daga: The reason I talked about all the demand footprint and demand new initiatives, I think cement will easily get absorbed. And if the demand remains strong, we will not see any problem in prices.

Amit Murarka: Understood. Sure. And just also on India Cements, like in Q3, I see that the EBITDA per ton was about INR400. You had earlier guided for INR1,000 exit in Q4 '27. So, most of this improvement will be through cost? Or will there also be some pricing required to achieve that.

Atul Daga: So, what will happen is the brand conversion, which has already taken place. Actually, had the brand conversion not taken place, the performance would have not been where it is today. Balance almost 40% or 45% of brand conversion has to be completed and prices are going up in the southern markets as well. Further, as I called out, the capex program has begun for efficiency improvement. So, we have to have all the players playing the match in a positive manner - prices, efficiency improvement and capacity utilization. All of them will deliver as planned.

Amit Murarka: Understood. Yes. And lastly, just if you could give the CC ratio for the quarter.

Atul Daga: 1.49.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Pulkit from Goldman Sachs.

Pulkit: And I echo Amit's views that these are good numbers. And on a lighter note, your opening remarks sounded a lot like the budget speech. But sir, I don't see the capacity addition plant-by-plant guidance for Q4 and for the next 2 years. Just the numbers around how much capacity would be added in Q4, how much in FY '27 and FY '28, that will be helpful.

Atul Daga: So, we should have approximately 8 to 9 million tons more coming in this quarter. And the balance, 12 million tons in fiscal '27 and then balance remaining will be in '28.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Jashandeep Singh Chadha: from Nomura.

Jashandeep Chadha: Congratulations on a great set of numbers, sir. And I must start by saying that the information and detail that you gave on the project is much better than most of the department who are actually working on those projects, I must say. So, my first question is you have covered most of the demand aspect and in a lot of detail?

Just wanted to shift the focus on rural demand. How has rural demand recovered in third quarter?

How are you seeing in the fourth quarter? And what are your expectations for the year ahead?

And just related to that, any expectation from the budget for the cement sector or anything?

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Atul Daga: The last question first, I won't comment on that. Rural demand, simple way to look at rural demand is look at our trade ratios. If our trade ratios remain strong, rural demand is equally buoyant. We are not witnessing any depression in rural demand. Q4 also will be solid is what my expectation is.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood, sir. And sir, on the cost saving front, UltraTech has given a target of INR300 to INR350 per ton over the next couple of years. I understand it's very difficult to tell the details quarter-by-quarter, but if you can give us the sense how much of this has been realized? And how much of that will be coming in the coming quarters?

Atul Daga: So you're asking 2 things in the same question. First, you are saying it is difficult to quantify and then you are saying quantify. So please have mercy. No, it's very difficult and it's not logical, Jashandeep, because July-September quarter will be weak, so costs can go up. January-March will show extraordinarily high delivery. So, it is best to see the results on an annual basis. Now to give you directions on how things are moving, and we had given our program with item details and with the targets. I recall we had mentioned with the base of 400 kilometers of lead, a 25-kilometer lead reduction, which would have taken us to 375 kilometers. We have already reached 363 kilometers. So, it's not only the lead distance, which helps, there is a lot of other initiatives which the team is taking, which helps to take efficiency improvement. Similarly, we have taken a target of clinker conversion factor of 1.54. We are moving on that direction. In 1.54, we have reached INR1.49. So, you can do your own math, but it will be best that we do this math at the end of the year. All I can say is we are moving and in line with the target set. Last year, full

year, on those quantified measurable targets, we have delivered INR86 per ton. My guess is we should be crossing INR100 mark on those efficiency improvement programs in this financial year.

Jhanwar-ji, you want to add.

K.C. Jhanwar: Yes, I think Atul has already explained because it's not item-wise see, we have moved from clinker conversion from 1.45 to 1.49, and we are still away from our target actually. And if you talk about the renewal energy, our renewal energy has gone to almost 41% kind of thing, and it is further likely to go to 60% going forward actually.

So, I can say that fundamentally, we are by and large, on track because quarter-to-quarter, we have seen in 1 quarter because of the cyclical nature of the industry, we may be up and down. But year as a whole, I think we are very much on the right track.

Atul Daga: Thanks, Jhanwar-ji.

Jashandeep Chadha: Just one last, if I can squeeze in. Any impact of increasing input costs you are seeing in fourth quarter?

Atul Daga: You tell me where the dollar will be in fourth quarter. So it's very difficult, but I think we are managing our middle line very well. You would have seen our fuel costs have remained at INR1.8 per kcal in this quarter. I don't expect the cost to go up. Raw material costs are already matured. These are the 2 big cost items, maintenance costs, which spikes typically in July, September will be normal maintenance costs in January-March quarter.

Jashandeep Chadha: Understood, sir. I'll join back the queue.

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Atul Daga: Thank you.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Rahul Gupta from Morgan Stanley.

Rahul Gupta: Again, sorry to echo again, a very good set of numbers. You talked about cost inflation and improved demand will support cement prices from here on. Now it looks like the infra demand is coming back, which should drive low pricing non-trade segment higher. Does that mean that even if cement prices move up, realization may remain under pressure over the next year or so? Any color on this will be very helpful.

Atul Daga: So firstly, Rahul, I like the echo that you talked about. Always good to hear good performance from as many people. Coming to your first question, even if infra demand is going, non-trade prices will also harden. So, I don't see any reason why there should be any problem. In fact, if you go back 2 or 3 quarters, the gap between non-trade and trade prices had narrowed dramatically. Rahul, are you there? Hello?

Rahul Gupta: Yes, yes. No, this is very helpful. I don't have any other questions.

Atul Daga: Thank you.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Pinakin Parekh from HSBC.

Pinakin Parekh: Sir, again, many congratulations, very good number. We understand that demand and pricing both have improved in January. But to go back to what happened in the December quarter. Now we understand that in the last 2 years, there have been multiple acquisitions done in Southern India, you and other industry players, expectations of Southern India pricing seeing more stability with upward bias, but somehow that has not taking place. What in your view needs to change in industry dynamics in South for pricing to be more stable with upward bias?

Atul Daga: More demand. I think demand is opening up, and I stand by my statement South will be new north. That doesn't mean North is going away anywhere. North is stronger and stronger. South is witnessing large institutional demand, the Amravati City project, which is going at its breakneck pace, the IT complexes. Complexes which are coming up, data centers which are coming up, which are so cementitious in nature, highways, et cetera, that we have talked about. And the young population in these IT hubs will demand more housing and more social infrastructure. So, I'm not talking about 1 quarter, Pinakin, but as we as strategic players are looking at a long-term

stability and reliability of the sector.

Pinakin Parekh: Got it, sir. Sir, just to follow up in your view and given what the position UltraTech is at, if finally, the institutional demand, as you highlighted, starts coming up in a big way in Southern India, can 2026 see a break in terms of South India's historically volatile cement pricing? Or do you see this as something evolving more over the next 2, 3 years?

Atul Daga: I think '26 will be a fabulous year.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Ritesh Shah from Investec.

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Ritesh Shah: Good numbers, congratulations. Sir, 3 questions. One is, would you be able to spell out industry demand growth for Q3 and 9 months?

Atul Daga: Don't hold me to it, but we would expect anywhere between 9% to 10% all-India demand.

Ritesh Shah: Sir, would you speak for Q3?

Atul Daga: I was talking about Q3 literally.

Ritesh Shah: Yes, yes. And sir, for 9 months?

K.C. Jhanwar: For the year as a whole must be about 7.5% kind of thing.

Atul Daga: 6.5 % to 7%, 9 months.

Ritesh Shah: Sure. Sir, my second question is, basically, if you could provide some detail around sourcing of fly ash and slag. What is the sort of nature of contracts that we have on tenure and how is the pricing that's trending?

Atul Daga: So, one is there's enough new supply coming up. Power plant capacities are going up, steel plants are coming up. And we have a mix of long-term, short-term domestic and import sourcing, fully secured.

Ritesh Shah: Sir, so putting this demand aside, if we had to improve a clinker factor, is there any limiting factor?

Atul Daga: No. No, none whatsoever.

Ritesh Shah: Okay. And sir, when you say imports, it means imports for both fly ash as well as slag?

Atul Daga: No, slag.

Ritesh Shah: Only slag, okay. That's helpful. Sir, third question on India Cements. Anything on non-core asset sale? And any thoughts on merger, basically simplifying the structure? Any time lines around that?

Atul Daga: Noncore there are land parcels essentially. We just sold off the coal mining company in Indonesia. The monies have been realized, and that's how you see the debt remaining under control. There are a couple of big land parcels, which we are discussing with potential buyers. I would expect further generation of up to INR500 crores minimum, which we should be able to get. We are now getting into, exploring the legal options in terms of there's an ED case, which is attached to the company, the assets of the company are also attached. There's a property in Hyderabad and some financial securities, which are attached. We are seeking legal opinion what will be the implications of that case, and then only we'll take a decision further.

Ritesh Shah: Sir, just a follow-up over here. I think just correct me if I'm wrong, for India Cements, you had indicated INR144 crores spend out of INR601 crores, are those numbers right?

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Atul Daga: Correct.

Ritesh Shah: Okay. And sir, when we say non-core asset sales, incrementally, it's INR500 crores. And what has been realized so far?

Atul Daga: Close to INR200 crores or INR250 crores. I'll give you exact number. That's a very easy number. If I can't give it on the call, you can reach out to, Ankit, later.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Satyadeep Jain from AMBIT Capital.

Satyadeep Jain: Just one clarification question on the capex. Mr. Daga, you mentioned having 12 million ton next year and balance in '28. Just wanted to clarify the phased 22 million tons that you've announced, all of that is likely to get commissioned in FY '28 given you've already placed

orders?

Atul Daga: Yes, please.

Satyadeep Jain: Okay. Nothing still. As of now, you're not expecting anything to spill over into FY '29?

Atul Daga: No, '29 is too far.

Satyadeep Jain: Okay.

Atul Daga: At best

a delay by a quarter. Some project will get preponed and some project could push over to the next quarter at best.

Satyadeep Jain: Okay. Maybe in the next one, is it possible like historically, you used to have this quarterly projection for when you expect capacities to commission for the next one that you have since you already have what...

Atul Daga: Sure. We'll send it.

Satyadeep Jain: And on the power cost, I see your captive power cost has been declining each quarter. Just what is driving that?

Atul Daga: No, that is the average cost of power. So, capex on the power, which has gone from INR7.1 crores to INR6.5 crores. Look, fuel efficiency is the only reason which I could think of, nothing more.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Ashish Jain from Macquarie.

Ashish Jain: Sir, my first question is like all the demand...

Atul Daga: My first question to you, Ashish, how are my numbers?

Ashish Jain: Numbers are fantastic, sir, a lot of people have spoken about this, sir.

Atul Daga: Okay.

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Ashish Jain: No, no, numbers are fantastic without doubt it. So, sir, like given most of the drivers you spoke about, are all infra-led demand, right? And so, can we see a change in mix moving from PPC to OPC, you think that will happen in the next 3, 4 years in the industry?

Atul Daga: In fact, what we could see is intra demand converting to non-OPC also. There's a lot of strong advocacy happening, and there is a gradual conversion. You will know that most of the institutional players do the conversion or mixing at the project site. So instead of we doing it, some of them have started adopting and accepting the product from the cement manufacturer.

RMC, it's about 3% of our total volumes of cement and growing rapidly, where it is getting consumed, large portion goes to institutional markets. Bulk cement is going up significantly, which will help the institutional market, gives us better margins, price remaining the same margins improve. So that's very important.

Ashish Jain: Sir, sorry. But in fact, that was the context of my question that if on-site blending is going up, can it mean that...

Atul Daga: No, it's going down.

Ashish Jain: Okay. Okay. Because of RMC I think but...

Atul Daga: That is what I talked about advocacy and there is a conversion happening, slowly it's happening.

Ashish Jain: Right. Yes

Atul Daga: Okay. Hello? Are you there? I think he lost the connection, take the next person, please.

Moderator: Yes. We have the next question from the line of Indrajit Agarwal from CLSA.

Indrajit Agarwal: I have 2 questions, sir. Sir, first, can you highlight what is the spot pet coke price versus the booking levels in 3Q?

Atul Daga: Around 118, 117.

K.C. Jhanwar: 118, 119, ranging in the trend.

Indrajit Agarwal: Sure. This is helpful. And second, in 3Q versus, let's say, a 3% kind of price decline sequentially, how would you split it between trade and nontrade? Was non-trade drop much sharper?

Atul Daga: Non-trade was sharper.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Raashi from Citigroup.

Raashi: Sir, just continuing on the pricing question, where are we on pricing versus 3Q at the moment?

Atul Daga: I think we are roughly INR3 to INR4 on a naked cement realization basis up. If naked cement realization is up INR3 to INR4, prices are up, it's somewhere around INR6 to INR8. Are you there?

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Raashi: Yes, what I'm trying to get to is that you also made a comment, of course, on demand, but on that you will be able to pass on the higher cost impact in the form of better pricing.

Atul Daga: I think what is happening is, I'm sold out. What do I do? So obviously, if I'm in a sold-out

position, I have to service my highest paying customer.

Raashi: Understood. Fair enough. Okay. Got that. Again, on the capacity, is it possible to just for India

Cements capacity, what would be the number by the end of '26, '27 and '28 in the asking. Sorry,

I didn't mean India Cements, I meant your Indian capacity not of India Cements.

Atul Daga: 235 by FY fiscal '28.

Raashi: Fiscal '26 and '27, if you have the number?

Atul Daga: '26 should be 198, 199 and then 12 more million tons in towards '27, yes. We missed that chart, we'll circulate that chart separately.

Raashi: Got it. And just on Kesoram in the second quarter, you had indicated the EBITDA per ton was INR755, what is that number in this quarter?

Atul Daga: Would be around INR600 this quarter.

Raashi: And the full rebranding is still maintaining June '26, okay for now?

Atul Daga: We should be doing it in time. Because we have already crossed the 70% mark for Kesoram as we speak. And India Cements also, we have crossed around 55%. I don't remember the exact number, but every day is a new high.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Siddharth Mehrotra from Kotak Securities.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Congratulations for a great set of numbers. Sir, just wanted to understand, given the strong volume growth we've witnessed this quarter, what is your approximation of UltraTech's market share going for this quarter? And sort of where do you sort of aspire to be, say, 2 to 3 years down the line?

Atul Daga: I wouldn't know a number on market share, but if you see that we have been growing or our capacity utilization has been higher than the industry, then obviously, there is a gain in market share also. There's no published data available to capture that number realistically. And going forward, I expect to see the same trend. As for aspiration, there's no aspiration. I think we are looking at how India is growing, where the growth opportunity is, and we will keep growing with India's growth story.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Got it, sir. And just coming back to consolidation, do you think there are additional targets which you would want to sort of look at just from a consolidating point of view so that you have better control on perhaps the industry dynamics as well? Are there any potential opportunities still under consideration, so over the next 1 or 18 months?

Atul Daga: It's highly opportunistic. We would love to examine opportunities if they come to the table.

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Siddharth Mehrotra: Okay. But nothing is in progress as we speak? Okay, sir, then that's it.

Atul Daga: Thank you.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Harsh Mittal from Emkay Global Financial Services.

Harsh Mittal: So, my first question is that what has been the clinker capacity additions till date in FY '26? And what will be the addition in quarter 4, this ongoing quarter?

K.C. Jhanwar: Yes, we have added 2 lines actually one is almost 10,000 TPD, yes, and translate into almost 3.5 million tons per year. And another one more line of 3.5 million ton in Rajasthan.

Atul Daga: That's 7 million tons of capacity. One in Nathdwara and one in Maihar.

Harsh Mittal: Sure. Sir, second question is what is the premium share this quarter? It's not been there in the PPT?

Atul Daga: We missed that. Premium share is 36%.

Harsh Mittal: Okay.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Andrey Purushottam from Cogito Advisors.

Andrey Purushottam: Congratulations on great set of numbers. And I wanted to ask, when I was going through the presentation, I found that your EBITDA is up considerably. But your costs, some have gone up, some have gone down, right? Your raw material costs have gone up and your fuel and logistics costs have gone down. Now given that your net realizations are also slightly lower, can one assume that the increase in EBITDA is almost entirely out of operating leverage? And if that is the case, if you're adding 8 million and 12 million tons capacity in the next quarter/next year, respectively, what

can we see as the trajectory and the effect of operating leverage going forward? Could you just lend some color on that?

Atul Daga: So operating leverage, obviously, will keep on playing a positive impact on efficiency improvement. Prices were a dampener on the profitability, but volumes, which gave me operating leverage and cost management, very efficient and tight cost management. Of course, you cannot manage all the line items of cost, but the management team's focus always remains on running a very tight P&L. So that's what is reflected in the performance in the quarter.

K.C. Jhanwar: And the third one you asked about the raw material pricing. It's obviously, the clinker conversion

ratio has improved. So, the raw material price will definitely increase, but the benefit we will get partially in the power and fuel side.

Andrey Purushottam: Okay. So, we basically should see an increase in EBITDA per ton over the next 15 months?

K.C. Jhanwar: Definitely, without a doubt.

Andrey Purushottam: And would there be a numerical guidance that you would be able to provide in the range.

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K.C. Jhanwar: No, we don't give guidance.

Andrey Purushottam: Okay.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Girija Ray from YES Securities.

Girija Ray: Congratulations. This is a superb number I can say, which is beyond market expectation. So, sir, my question is related to employee cost. Is this a one-off for this quarter? And second question, can I expect INR1,100 to INR1,200 kind of EBITDA per ton for fourth quarter?

Atul Daga: To your second question, we will do much better than what we did this quarter. I don't want to get into any specific number. And 916 employee cost going up Y-o-Y because what happens is our annual compensation increases that take place and new plants, of course, new capacity getting added. That is what will reflect in this cost. What you ideally should compare, if you look at Q2, you will not see dramatic movement.

Girija Ray: Okay. And thanks for saying that fourth quarter, we'll be doing a very good EBITDA per ton.

That's all from my side, sir.

Atul Daga: Thank you.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Navin Sahadeo from ICICI Securities.

Navin Sahadeo: Of course, congratulations on the robust volume growth that you have demonstrated. Two questions. One is your other operating income, just the difference between the net revenues and net sales that you report. Sequentially, it has got increased by almost about INR88 crores. And this was also the first wherein quarter in the incentives would have likely dropped on a pro rata basis in the sense, if earlier we got incentives at 28%, now we get at more like 18% on a base. I'm just comparing. So, is there anything one-off that we got in this particular revenue item?

Atul Daga: So, Navin, what happens is that new incentives kick in, sometimes old incentives get exhausted. Case in point, our Dhar line 1 got exhausted, whatever was the balancing quantum of money left and Dhar 2 kicked in. Then also a bigger thing and very difficult to show a trend line is volumes moving from the plant to which market. Depending upon the concentration of demand in the local market, the incentives will go up or down.

Navin Sahadeo: Helpful. My second question was on India Cements. And of course, the company has done a remarkable performance there on the cost front. This quarter, in particular, the freight cost flipped, I would rather say, plunged significantly, almost 27% plus quarter-on-quarter on a per ton basis. So, wanted to understand, is this the new normal because a higher brand transition has happened, so you can sell in a lower lead catchment area? Or this is anything one-off? That's my question.

Atul Daga: Yes. So, it's a combination. And obviously, when brand transition gets completed fully, you will see the real benefit. New foot

print will also get captured. So, this is not a one-off. We're ready to go down further. Difficult for me to say at this juncture. Perhaps we will talk about it in April-June quarter.

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Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Shravan Shah from Dolat Capital.

Shravan Shah: Congratulation on strong volume growth. Most of the questions answered, a couple of clarifications and questions. So first, 9-month capex, what was the number? And for full year FY '26, '27, '28 previously, we said INR10,000-odd crores. So that guidance remains intact?

Atul Daga: INR7,000 crores to INR7,200 crores is 9 months and yes INR2,000 crores to INR2,500 crores will get spent in this quarter. So anywhere around INR9,500 crores, INR10,000 crores.

Shravan Shah: Got it. And sir, in the next year, FY '27, when we say 12 million tons we want to add, any ballpark idea in terms of 1H FY '27, will it be a 5 million, 6 million tons that we will be adding?

Atul Daga: You want me to tell you what date will we be commissioning and at what hour we will start the shipment, give us that flexibility to commission as fast as possible, Shravan, don't hang me for exact number or exact period.

Shravan Shah: No, no, I'm saying. 1H FY '27, in this -- so in the first 6 months of FY '27, will it fair to assume 5 million, 6 million tons we will be adding?

K.C. Jhanwar: 4 million to 5 million tons, but it all depends, as you know, Shravan, because there are multiple

moving parts. So sometimes things get delayed and kind of thing. But yes, I can guess maybe 4 to 5 million tons.
Shravan Shah: Okay. And in terms of the demand for fourth quarter of this quarter, FY '26, will it 7% to 9% that we are expecting? And for next 4, 5 years, normally what we guided in corporate 7% to 8%.
So that number remains intact.

Atul Daga: That remains. That remains, Shravan.

Shravan Shah: And then for this quarter, fourth quarter, would it be a 9%, 10% or 7%, 8%.

K.C. Jhanwar: No, I don't think. 9%, 10% may be a little optimistic, but difficult to say because the last year base itself was, all we know is the good base. But yes, all I think it is going to be the robust demand actually.

Shravan Shah: Okay. Got it. And this 1.54 CC ratio target, that is by FY '27, we are looking at?

Atul Daga: In the middle of FY '27 and FY '28, when we complete the previous phase of expansion between FY '27, FY '28.

Shravan Shah: And the green share from currently 42% to 60% by FY '27, we will be reaching?

Atul Daga: Yes. So '27 or first half of '28, so just giving us a flexibility of some delays.

Shravan Shah: Okay. And last a clarification, in terms of price, when we said INR3 crores, INR4, price hike would have already happened versus third quarter of average, though this is including trade non-trade put together?

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Atul Daga: Average, yes.

Shravan Shah: Okay. All the best.

Atul Daga: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Ladies and gentlemen, as there are no further questions from the participants. That concludes the question-and answer session. On behalf of UltraTech Cement Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining with us today, and you may now disconnect your lines.

Disclaimer - The transcript has been edited for language and grammar; it however may not be a verbatim representation of the call.

Call: May 2026

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